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SWNCC 181/2

10 September 1945

Pages 11 and 12

STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE

AUTHORITY OF THE SUPREME COMMANDER FOR THE ALLIED POWERS

References: a. SWNCC 181/1
b. JCS 1467/4

Note by the Secretaries

The enclosure, a memorandum from the Deputy Secretary, Joint Chiefs of Staff to the State-War-Navy Coordinating Committee, is circulated for consideration by the Committee.

CHARLES W. McCARTHY
ALVIN F. RICHARDSON
RAYMOND E. COX
Secretariat

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13 September 1945

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STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE

CORRIGENDUM
TO
SWNCC 181/2

AUTHORITY OF THE SUPREME COMMANDER FOR THE ALLIED POWERS

Note by the Secretaries

Comply

Holders of SWNCC 181/2 are requested to substitute the attached cover page for the one contained therein and destroy the latter by burning.

CHARLES W. McCARTHY
ALVIN F. RICHARDSON
RAYMOND E. COX
Secretariat

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ENCLOSURE

THE JOINT CHIEFS OF STAFF
Washington 25, D. C.

SM-3295
9 September 1945

MEMORANDUM FOR THE STATE-WAR-NAVY COORDINATING COMMITTEE:

Subject: Authority of the Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers.

References: a. SWNCC 181/1
b. JCS 1467/4

The following message from General MacArthur has been received by the Joint Chiefs of Staff:

"8 September 1945

"It would have a most beneficial and salutary effect if the instructions and powers of the Supreme Commander contained in your WX 60333 (Appendix "B" to SWNCC 181/1) (Appendix) were published. Is there any objection?"

The Joint Chiefs of Staff will be pleased to transmit to General MacArthur a reply determined upon by the State-War-Navy Coordinating Committee.

For the Joint Chiefs of Staff:

(signed) C. J. Moore
C. J. MOORE,
Captain, U.S.N.,
Deputy Secretary

TOP SECRET

APPENDIX

Message Number 1

1. The authority of the Emperor and the Japanese Government to rule the State is subordinate to you as Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers. You will exercise your authority as you deem proper to carry out your mission. Our relations with Japan do not rest on a contractual basis, but on an unconditional surrender. Since your authority is supreme, you will not entertain any question on the part of the Japanese as to its scope.

2. Control of Japan shall be exercised through the Japanese Government to the extent that such an arrangement produces satisfactory results. This does not prejudice your right to act directly if required. You may enforce the orders issued by you by the employment of such measures as you deem necessary, including the use of force.

3. The statement of intentions contained in the Potsdam Declaration will be given full effect. It will not be given effect, however, because we consider ourselves bound in a contractual relationship with Japan as a result of that document. It will be respected and given effect because the Potsdam Declaration forms a part of our policy stated in good faith with relation to Japan and with relation to peace and security in the Far East.